



Providing Creative Solutions to Common Problems

RESIDENTIAL CONSUMER RECEIVABLES RECOVERY · CAPABILITIES OVERVIEW

Consumer Debt Collection for Contractors

Recovering homeowner balances on completed water-main & sewer work — compliantly, on pure contingency

Prepared for **Harris Water Main & Sewer Contractors** · July 2026

The consumer-side partner your commercial agency isn't

To Dea and the Harris team — thank you for the clear brief. You already have a commercial agency for your B2B book; what you need is different: a specialist for individual homeowners who haven't paid for completed water-main and sewer work — consumer accounts, worked under consumer rules, by people who do exactly that every day.

Your residential receivable is unusually strong — and deserves a specialist. Much of your work is city-mandated: a DEP cease & desist or 3-day notice meant the homeowner had no choice but to order the repair. The job is done, permitted and inspected. What's missing is only the payment — and that's recoverable.

Southwest Recovery Services works consumer accounts under the **FDCPA and CFPB Regulation F in 47 states, including New York** — on pure contingency since 2004, licensed and bonded where required. We operate strictly as the **consumer-side complement** to your existing commercial agency: your batch uploads through a secure portal as a simple spreadsheet, and outreach begins within 24–48 hours. No recovery, no fee.

Two decades of consumer recovery — with a deep residential-trades book

A documented, compliant consumer practice — proven at volume on exactly your receivable: homeowner balances owed to plumbing, water and sewer contractors.

2004 Recovering commercial receivables since	\$975M+ Receivables placed (all industries)	\$76M+ Recovered for clients	800K+ Accounts worked
52% of placed accounts see a recovery	50 states — nationwide recovery reach	4.9★ Google client rating	\$0 upfront — no recovery, no fee

FDCPA / CFPB Reg F / FCRA compliant

Consumer recovery in 47 states incl. New York

Experian-powered skip tracing (daily)

All-three-bureau credit reporting

Contingency — no recovery, no fee

RECOGNIZED & FEATURED BY

USA TODAY

FINANCIAL SERVICES
Review

FSR • TOP 10 LIST
2025 Recognition

INTERNATIONAL
Business Times

CFO Tech
Outlook

insideARM

ACCREDITED & RECOGNIZED



 ★ 4.9 · 38 Google reviews

Memberships: **ACA International** · TAA · AAGD · NARPM

Your three questions — answered directly

Straight from your note, in order — plus the three things a 108-year firm will want to know next.

YOUR QUESTION	SOUTHWEST RECOVERY SERVICES
1. Do you handle individual / residential consumer accounts?	Yes — consumer recovery is a core SWRS practice, not a sideline. Homeowner accounts are worked under the FDCPA and CFPB Regulation F in 47 states including New York, by collectors trained specifically for consumer contact. Our residential-trades book includes plumbing and home-services programs worked at hundreds-of-accounts scale.
2. What is your fee structure?	Pure contingency — \$0 upfront, no retainer, no monthly minimum. You pay a pre-agreed percentage only of what we actually recover; if we recover nothing, you owe nothing. The rate is quoted against a representative sample of your batch — account ages, balance sizes and documentation drive it — the same model you already know from your commercial agency, applied by a consumer specialist.
3. What does intake look like?	Built for exactly your situation: a batch, ready to go. Export the accounts from your billing system (or send a spreadsheet) and upload through our secure client portal — we map your columns once, no re-keying. Outreach begins within 24–48 hours of a documented placement, and your team has live portal visibility from day one.
Why your files are strong	Much of your residential work originates in DEP enforcement — cease & desist orders, 3-day and 10-day notices — so the homeowner was required to order the repair, and the job is permitted and inspected. That paper trail neutralizes the most common consumer disputes and supports credit-bureau furnishing on qualifying accounts.
Homeowners who sold and moved	The hardest residential debtor is the one who sold the property and left. Experian-powered skip tracing — run daily on placed accounts — locates former owners at their next address, with refreshed phone and employment data for as long as we work the account.
Will this reflect well on a 108-year name?	It has to. Contact is professional, documented and fully compliant — no threats, no pressure tactics. Your debtors are one-time customers, but your name is on trucks all over four boroughs; we collect like we know it.

Batch-ready intake and full visibility for your office

Every placement is managed through our secure portal — built so an executive assistant can place a batch and leadership can watch recovery in real time.

BATCH UPLOAD, MAPPED ONCE

Send the batch as a spreadsheet or billing-system export — we map your columns the first time, and every future placement takes minutes.

SECURE DOCUMENT EXCHANGE

Contracts, DEP notices, permits and inspection records move safely inside the portal — the paper that makes your files strong.

REAL-TIME REPORTING

Live status, recoveries and remittances on demand — the numbers leadership wants without asking anyone to compile them.

DIRECT-PAYMENT REPORTING

Log payments a homeowner makes directly to Harris, so balances stay accurate and no one is over-contacted.

► **Portal Video Tour**

SWRS Residential-Trades Recovery Case Studies

Actual placed-versus-recovered results from Southwest Recovery's **plumbing, home-services and restoration book** — homeowner (consumer) balances owed to contractors for completed work — anonymized by sub-sector, individual client names withheld.

PLUMBING & AC SERVICE

COMPANY

Residential accounts · 289 placed

\$309K recovered

of ~\$773K placed

40% recovered

WATER-DAMAGE

RESTORATION

Completed-job homeowner balance

\$44K recovered

of ~\$48K placed

92% recovered

BUILDING RESTORATION

CONTRACTOR

Masonry & tuckpointing

\$35K recovered

of ~\$41K placed

84% recovered

RESIDENTIAL PLUMBING

CONTRACTOR

Service & repair accounts

\$35K recovered

of ~\$44K placed

79% recovered

RESIDENTIAL PLUMBING

COMPANY

105 accounts placed

\$70K recovered

of ~\$151K placed

47% recovered

DRAIN & ROOTER FRANCHISE

Aged residential accounts

\$85K recovered

of ~\$430K placed

20% recovered

Anonymized by sector from Southwest Recovery's book; individual client names withheld. Results vary by account age, balance, documentation quality and industry. We do not publish blended portfolio averages.

THE AGE CURVE

Why completed-work balances recover best placed fresh

Look at the spread above: fresh, well-documented completed-work balances recover at 79–92 cents on the dollar; aged residential accounts placed late recover 20. The balance didn't change — the trail did. Homeowners refinance, sell, and move; every month a batch sits, contact data decays and newer bills win.

THE AGE CURVE

Balances placed within ~90–120 days of completion resolve at several times the rate of accounts left a year or more.

THE STANDING RULE

Place the existing batch now — it costs nothing on contingency — then set a standing rule: completed-work balances place at 60–90 days, every month, automatically.

Real placed-versus-recovered results from SWRS's residential-trades book, anonymized; individual client names withheld. Results vary with account age, balance size and documentation — we give an honest, age-based read on a representative sample of your batch before quoting.

We understand a completed-work ledger

A homeowner balance for finished trade work is a specific kind of consumer account. Our playbook is built for exactly that.



City-mandated completed work

DEP cease & desist, 3-day and 10-day notice jobs — the homeowner had to order the repair; the permit and inspection prove it was delivered. We work the file on that paper.



Sold-and-moved homeowners

Daily Experian-powered skip tracing locates former owners at their next address — the step that makes recovery possible at all.



Bureau-grade leverage

Qualifying accounts report to all three major credit bureaus — the consequence that brings a five-figure balance to the table before anyone mentions court.



Complement, not conflict

We take the consumer side; your commercial agency keeps the B2B side. Clean lanes, no overlap, and a 108-year brand protected by documented, compliant conduct.

Recovery run on an AI-driven platform — Aktos

Every account SWRS works runs on Aktos, a next-generation, AI-driven collections platform — with compliance built into the workflow, not bolted on afterward. It's how a boutique, people-first agency delivers enterprise-grade speed, consistency, and auditability.



AI workflow automation

Repetitive steps are automated and every account is scored and routed by predicted payment likelihood — so the right strategy reaches the right account first, without manual queue-picking.



Omnichannel outreach

Coordinated email, SMS, and voice, timed to when a debtor is most likely to engage — replacing high-friction call blasts with respectful, data-driven contact.



Compliance built in

FDCPA, Reg F, and TCPA guardrails are enforced inside the automation, with phone-number and consent checks before outreach — documented and defensible on every account.



Real-time dashboards

You see status, segmentation, and recovery performance on your portfolio in real time — full transparency, not a monthly PDF.



API-first intake

Secure SFTP/API placement means accounts start working without data lag — roughly 50% faster acknowledgment and validation of new placements.



Data-driven scoring

Dynamic scoring and segmentation predict payment likelihood and concentrate effort where recovery is most achievable — earlier intervention that trims DSO and reduces disputes.

The result is the combination clients rarely get from a legacy agency: faster cash and cleaner compliance at the same time. Automation accelerates recovery and standardizes documentation, while empathy-first, data-driven contact protects your brand and keeps disputes and complaints low.

Built by a collector with 30 years on the phones — not a CEO with zero collection experience



Steven Dietz

Founder & Chief Executive Officer

Featured in USA Today, International Business Times & Financial Services Review — Top AR Management Service, 2025 · ACA International member.

Steven Dietz didn't come to collections from the corner office — he came from the phones. He started as a collector and credit analyst before he was 20, was tapped by Aaron's to train collectors across 100+ locations, and has spent nearly 30 years in receivables. Along the way he became convinced the industry's bad reputation was a choice, not a requirement: businesses get paid faster when recovery is built on listening and respect rather than aggressive calls and empty threats.

He founded Southwest Recovery Services in 2004 on that principle — a national, family-owned receivables partner that treats every debtor as a person and every client relationship as worth protecting. Two decades later he still coaches the teams and works accounts personally — an operator who has actually done the job, not a manager who has only overseen it.

“Regardless of the means of recovery, our focus is always on preserving goodwill and representing the client professionally.”

— Steven Dietz, Founder & Chief Executive Officer, Southwest Recovery Services

Take it with you

Download this overview and the supporting white papers to share with your team.



This capabilities overview

PDF · prepared for Harris Water Main & Sewer

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Consumer Collections, Done Right

FDCPA & Reg F recovery for homeowner accounts · PDF

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Customer-Focused Utility Collections

Diplomatic recovery that saves money long-term · PDF

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The Aktos Advantage

Our AI-driven collections platform · PDF

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The Experian Intelligence Advantage

Data & skip-tracing stack · PDF

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The Recovery Waterfall

Full recovery lifecycle · PDF

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The batch is ready. Let's find out what it's worth.

The call you offered: we'll answer anything your leadership wants to ask, walk the intake in ten minutes, and put a contingency rate against a representative sample of the batch — no upfront fee, no retainer, no minimum.

[Book a 30-minute discovery call →](#)

Steven Dietz

Founder & Chief Executive Officer

✉ sdietz@swrecovery.com

📞 (972) 984-5065

🌐 swrecovery.com



Southwest Recovery Services, LLC · 16200 Addison Road, Suite 260, Addison, TX 75001 · (866) 551-4684

12 offices across 7 states · nationwide recovery. Licensed & bonded where required. FDCPA / CFPB Reg F / FCRA compliant · ACA International member. Consumer collections in 47 states (not CA, OR or WA). Private & confidential — prepared for Harris Water Main & Sewer Contractors.